Northwind Consulting - Travel & Expense Policy (Fictional Sample)

1. Booking travel

All business travel must be booked through the company travel desk at least 7 days in advance. Bookings made with less notice need written approval from your manager. The travel desk compares fares from at least three airlines and books the lowest reasonable fare that fits your meeting schedule. Employees should share their itinerary, purpose of travel and cost centre when raising a request. Personal stopovers can be added only if they do not increase the cost to the company, and any extra cost must be paid by the employee directly to the travel desk before tickets are issued. Visa and travel insurance for international trips are arranged by the travel desk and paid by the company.

2. Expense claims

Expense claims must be submitted within 30 days of returning from the trip, with original receipts. Claims above 25,000 INR require approval from the finance team. Meals are reimbursed up to 1,500 INR per day in India and 60 EUR per day abroad. Alcohol, personal entertainment and traffic fines are never reimbursed. Local taxis and ride-hailing are allowed for business purposes; please choose the standard category. Claims submitted after 30 days are rejected unless the employee's manager confirms in writing that the delay was caused by business reasons. Reimbursements are paid with the next monthly salary.

3. Flights

Economy class is mandatory for flights shorter than 6 hours. Premium economy may be booked for longer flights with manager approval. Business class is reserved for directors and above. Seat upgrades paid with personal miles or money are allowed. Checked baggage is covered for trips longer than three days. Employees must check in online where possible and keep boarding passes, as they are required for expense claims. If a flight is cancelled, contact the travel desk's 24-hour helpline immediately so they can rebook you; do not buy a new ticket yourself unless the helpline cannot be reached.

4. Hotels

Hotel stays are capped at 8,000 INR per night in metro cities and 5,000 INR elsewhere. Abroad, the cap is 150 EUR per night. Employees should use the company's partner hotels when available, as they include breakfast and free cancellation. Room service, minibar and laundry for trips shorter than five days are not reimbursed. If you stay with friends or family instead of a hotel, you may claim a flat allowance of 1,000 INR per night. Hotel bills must be in the employee's name and show the company's GST number.